

Laurie Chandler — Post-Call Follow-Up

Discovery call completed 6/17 at noon. These items go out by end of day.

Draft the email from this doc — don't send this file.

1. What You Already Have (Free Tracking Tools)

You mentioned you have a Google Business Profile but don't really look at it. That's actually the first place to start — it's already working for you, you just need to check in on it.

Google Business Profile (you have this — it's free):

- Shows how many people found you through Google Search and Google Maps
- Shows what search terms people used to find you (e.g., "therapist near me," "Jungian therapist Marin")
- Tracks website clicks, phone calls, direction requests
- You can download reports to see trends over time
- You don't need to pay for anything — this comes with your existing profile

Google Search Console (free — we'd set this up for you):

- Shows exactly which Google searches lead people to your website
- Shows which pages on your site are showing up in search results
- Tracks how often your site appears in search vs. how often people click
- **New as of this month:** Google just launched AI search tracking — it now shows when your site appears in AI-generated answers on Google (AI Overviews). This is brand new and directly relevant to the SEO/GEO work we'd be doing for you.
- Free. Takes about 15 minutes to set up. We'd handle it as part of the build.

What this means for you: Between your Google Business Profile and Search Console, you'd be able to see — for free — whether people are finding you, how they're finding you, and whether that changes after we launch your new site. No extra cost, no third-party tools.

2. What a CMS Is (In Plain English)

You asked what CMS means. Here's the simplest way to think about it:

CMS = the admin area where you edit your own website.

Right now, your WordPress site has a dashboard where you go to change things — edit text, add pages, upload photos. A CMS is the same idea, just simpler and built specifically for what you need.

When we build your site, we'd create a custom admin area with just the pieces you actually use:

- A place to edit your homepage text
- A place to update your services or specialties
- A place to write and publish blog posts (if you want a blog)
- A place to swap out photos
- A place to update your contact info

No WordPress plugins, no theme editors, no confusing menus. Just the fields you need. You log in, make your change, hit save, and it's live.

You wouldn't need to know any code. If you can write an email, you can update your website.

What we'd use: One of the options we prefer is a tool called Payload — it's open-source, which means there are no licensing fees to you. We'd customize the admin panel to match exactly what your practice needs. You'd only see what's relevant to your site, not a generic dashboard with 50 options you'll never touch.

3. Hosting — What It Is and What It Costs

You mentioned WordPress is frustrating. Here's what the alternative looks like:

What "hosting" means: It's just where your website lives on the internet. Right now, your site lives on WordPress.com's servers. We'd move it to a different home — one that's faster, simpler, and cheaper.

What we'd recommend: A platform like Vercel. Here's why:

- **Cost: Free.** The hosting platform we use handles everything a therapist website needs. You get a fast, secure connection, your site loads quickly for anyone anywhere, and it automatically backs up. You don't have to pay anything for hosting.
- **Speed:** Sites built this way load significantly faster than WordPress. That matters because Google ranks faster sites higher, and visitors leave slow sites.
- **Security:** Your site gets a secure connection automatically — the padlock that shows up in the browser bar. No security updates to worry about, no plugins that can get hacked.
- **Simplicity:** No confusing admin pages, no database management. It just works.

If you needed more later (you won't for a solo practice): paid options exist for businesses with team features and high traffic — not what you'd need.

Your total hosting cost: \$0/month. The build itself is the one-time investment. Ongoing hosting is essentially free.

4. How We'd Track Whether It's Working

You asked a really good question: "How do I track whether it's successful?" Here's how, at two levels:

Level 1 — What you get for free (included in the build):

- Google Business Profile: views, clicks, calls, direction requests (you already have this)
- Google Search Console: search queries, click-through rates, AI search visibility (we'd set this up)
- Basic site analytics: how many people visit your site, which pages they look at, where they came from — this comes free with the hosting platform

That's enough to know: Are people finding me? Are they clicking through? Are they contacting me?

Level 2 — What's possible if you want more detail later:

This is something we can discuss as part of an ongoing arrangement. More detailed reporting — like which specific pages led to consultation requests, or month-over-month trend analysis — would be part of a conversation about what ongoing support looks like for your practice. We'd scope that to what you actually need, not a one-size-fits-all package.

5. What Happens Next

If you're interested in moving forward, here's what the process looks like:

1. We send you a simple agreement (Master Services Agreement + Statement of Work) — scope, timeline, and investment, all spelled out
2. You approve it, submit the 50% deposit
3. Lauren schedules your Discovery session (this call counts as a head start on that)
4. We build. You review. We launch. 30 days of support included.

No pressure on timing. If you want to think about it, that's fine. If you want to move forward, we can get started within a week of signing.

Tone Notes (for drafting the email)

- Warm, conversational, not salesy
- She responded to simplicity. Keep it short. Don't overload.
- She liked the neuroaesthetic angle — reference it once if natural
- She's cost-conscious — emphasize what's free
- Don't push for commitment. Give her what she asked for and let her sit with it
- Retainer pricing: DO NOT include specific numbers. Defer to the SOW conversation.
- Lauren should probably send this, or it should come from both of you

Calendar

☐ Block 2:45-3:45pm to draft and send follow-up email